Phase 7: God's Big Messengers

The Major Prophets: Isaiah, Jeremiah, Lamentations, Ezekiel & Daniel. God speaks, God warns, God comforts, and God promises a coming King.

At a Glance

Month	Month 7
Books covered	Isaiah, Jeremiah, Lamentations, Ezekiel, Daniel (**5 books**)
Bible section(s)	Major Prophets (Old Testament)
Big Idea	God sent messengers to tell His people the truth: turn back to Me, I still love you, and a Rescuer-King is coming.
Memory Verse (all ages)	"The grass withers and the flowers fall, but the word of our God endures forever." (Isaiah 40:8, NIV)
Little Lambs verse	"The word of our God endures forever." (Isaiah 40:8)
Theme color	Royal Purple (for the King the prophets pointed to)
Phase symbol / badge	📯 The Megaphone (a messenger's horn), "God's Big Messenger" badge
Running total of books learned	**27 of 66** (Law 5 + History 12 + Poetry/Wisdom 5 + Major Prophets 5)

> Cross-links: Program Overview · Teacher Training Guide · Books of the Bible Memory System · Game Library · YouTube Video Guide · Phase 7 Printables

The Big Idea (in kid words)

A **prophet** is a messenger. God gave prophets a message, and they told it to the people. God's people kept running away from Him and doing wrong things. So God sent His big messengers to say, "Come back! I love you!" They also told a secret about the future: **a Rescuer-King is coming!**

How this points to Jesus: The prophets were like people standing on a tall tower, pointing far down the road and shouting, "Here He comes!" Isaiah said a baby would be born who would be called "Mighty God" and "Prince of Peace." Jeremiah said God would make a new promise and write His ways on our hearts. Ezekiel said God would be our Good Shepherd. Daniel saw a "Son of Man" who would rule forever. Every one of those promises came true in **Jesus**. Jesus even called Himself the "Son of Man" from Daniel's vision!

The Books in Easy Words

> **Why "Major"?** These five books are called "Major" Prophets because they are **long** (big books), not because these prophets were more important than the "Minor" (shorter) Prophets we will learn next month. Lamentations is short, but it sits with Jeremiah because Jeremiah is its traditional author.

1. Isaiah 📜

How to say it	eye-ZAY-uh
How to spell it	I-sai-ah — **I-S-A-I-A-H** (tip: "I SAID A HOT dog... no, I-S-A-I-A-H!" There's an "I" at the start and an "I-A" in the middle.)
Section	Major Prophets (book 1 of 5)
Traditional author	The prophet Isaiah, son of Amoz (Isaiah 1:1), around 740–680 B.C. in Jerusalem
One-sentence kid summary	Isaiah told God's people to stop doing wrong and promised that God would send a special Child, a Servant-King, to save them.
In one word	**Savior** (Isaiah's name means "The LORD saves")
Key people	Isaiah, King Uzziah, King Ahaz, King Hezekiah, the seraphim (angel-like creatures), the Assyrian king Sennacherib
Key stories	Isaiah sees God on His throne and a coal touches his lips: "Here am I. Send me!" (ch. 6); the sign of Immanuel (ch. 7); "For to us a child is born" (ch. 9); God rescues Jerusalem from the Assyrian army (ch. 36–37); "Comfort, comfort my people" and soaring on wings like eagles (ch. 40); the Suffering Servant (ch. 53); a new heaven and new earth (ch. 65–66)
Where Jesus shows up	Immanuel, "God with us" (7:14 → Matthew 1:23); "Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace" (9:6); the Servant "pierced for our transgressions" (53:5) → the cross; Jesus read Isaiah 61 in His hometown synagogue and said, "Today this scripture is fulfilled" (Luke 4:16–21).
Hand motion / symbol	🔥 **Hot coal on the lips**: touch two fingers to your lips, then point up and shout "Send me!"

> Fun fact: Isaiah has **66 chapters**, the same number as the books in the whole Bible. Some teachers call it "the Bible in miniature." (It's a fun coincidence, not a secret code!)

2. Jeremiah 🏺

How to say it	jair-uh-MY-uh
How to spell it	Jer-e-mi-ah — **J-E-R-E-M-I-A-H**
Section	Major Prophets (book 2 of 5)

Traditional author	The prophet Jeremiah (with his helper and scribe Baruch, Jeremiah 36:4), around 627–580 B.C.
One-sentence kid summary	Jeremiah, the "weeping prophet," warned Jerusalem for 40 years that it would fall if the people did not turn back to God, and he was right, but God also promised a brand-new covenant.
In one word	**Warning** (and **New Promise**)
Key people	Jeremiah, Baruch the scribe, King Josiah, King Jehoiakim, King Zedekiah, Ebed-Melek (who rescued Jeremiah), King Nebuchadnezzar of Babylon
Key stories	God calls young Jeremiah: "Do not say, 'I am too young'" (ch. 1); the potter and the clay (ch. 18); a letter to the exiles: "For I know the plans I have for you" (29:11); the new covenant (31:31–34); the king cuts up and burns Jeremiah's scroll (ch. 36); Jeremiah is lowered into a muddy cistern and rescued (ch. 38); Jerusalem falls to Babylon (ch. 39 & 52)
Where Jesus shows up	The **new covenant** (31:31–34). At the Last Supper, Jesus said, "This cup is the new covenant in my blood" (Luke 22:20). Jeremiah also promised a "righteous Branch" from David's family (23:5).
Hand motion / symbol	🏺 **Potter's hands**: cup your hands and "shape clay" in a circle.

3. Lamentations 😢

How to say it	lam-en-TAY-shuns
How to spell it	Lam-en-ta-tions — **L-A-M-E-N-T-A-T-I-O-N-S** (tip: it has "LAMENT" + "ATIONS". A lament is a sad song.)
Section	Major Prophets (book 3 of 5)
Traditional author	Jeremiah (tradition; the book itself doesn't name its author), written soon after Jerusalem fell in 586 B.C.
One-sentence kid summary	Lamentations is five sad poems crying over broken Jerusalem, but right in the middle it says God's love is new every morning.
In one word	**Tears** (with hope in the middle)
Key people	The poet (Jeremiah), the people of Jerusalem (pictured as "Daughter Zion")
Key stories	There's no action story. It's poetry. Four of the five poems are ABC poems (acrostics) using the Hebrew alphabet. The hope-filled center: "Because of the LORD's great love we are not consumed, for his compassions never fail. They are new every morning; great is your faithfulness." (3:22–23)
Where Jesus shows up	Jesus also wept over Jerusalem (Luke 19:41). God's never-failing love in 3:22–23 is shown most fully at the cross. Jesus is the "Man of Sorrows" who carried our sadness.
Hand motion / symbol	😢→🌅 **Tears to sunrise**: trace tears down your cheeks with your fingers, then sweep your arms up like the sun rising ("New every morning!").

4. Ezekiel 🦴

How to say it	ih-ZEE-kee-ul
How to spell it	E-ze-ki-el — **E-Z-E-K-I-E-L** (tip: "E-Z" like "easy" + "KIEL." Two E's around the Z, then "K-I-E-L.")
Section	Major Prophets (book 4 of 5)
Traditional author	Ezekiel, a priest who was taken to Babylon as a captive in 597 B.C. (Ezekiel 1:1–3)
One-sentence kid summary	Ezekiel saw amazing visions of God's glory while far away in Babylon, and God showed him that He could even bring dry bones back to life.
In one word	**Glory** (and **New Life**)
Key people	Ezekiel, the four living creatures, the exiles by the Kebar River
Key stories	The vision of God's glory with wheels within wheels (ch. 1); Ezekiel eats a scroll that tastes like honey (ch. 3); the watchman on the wall (ch. 3 & 33); God's glory leaves the temple (ch. 10); God the Good Shepherd (ch. 34); a new heart (36:26); the Valley of Dry Bones (ch. 37); a river flowing from a new temple (ch. 47); the city's new name: "THE LORD IS THERE" (48:35)
Where Jesus shows up	"I myself will search for my sheep" (34:11) → Jesus: "I am the good shepherd" (John 10:11). New heart and Spirit (36:26–27) → the Holy Spirit given through Jesus. The river of life (47) → Jesus offers "living water" (John 7:37–38).
Hand motion / symbol	🦴 **Dry bones wake up**: flop like a floppy skeleton, then stand up straight and tall!

5. Daniel 🦁

How to say it	DAN-yul
How to spell it	Dan-iel — **D-A-N-I-E-L**
Section	Major Prophets (book 5 of 5)
Traditional author	Daniel, a young man from Judah taken to Babylon in 605 B.C., who served kings for about 70 years
One-sentence kid summary	Daniel and his friends stayed faithful to God in Babylon, and God protected them in a blazing furnace and a den of lions and showed Daniel that His kingdom will last forever.
In one word	**Faithful**
Key people	Daniel (Babylonian name Belteshazzar), Shadrach, Meshach & Abednego (Hebrew names Hananiah, Mishael & Azariah), King Nebuchadnezzar, King Belshazzar, King Darius, the angel Gabriel
Key stories	Vegetables and water for 10 days (ch. 1); the king's dream of a giant statue (ch. 2); the blazing furnace, and a fourth man in the fire (ch. 3); proud Nebuchadnezzar eats grass like a cow (ch. 4); the handwriting on the wall (ch. 5); the lions' den (ch. 6); the vision of the "son of man" coming with the clouds (ch. 7)

Where Jesus shows up	The "son of man" given an everlasting kingdom (7:13–14). Jesus called Himself "the Son of Man" more than any other name, and quoted Daniel 7 at His trial (Mark 14:62). The rock "not cut by human hands" that becomes a mountain (2:34–35, 44) pictures God's never-ending kingdom.
Hand motion / symbol	🦁 **Lion's mouth shut**: open your hands like a roaring lion's jaws, then clap them shut!

Section summary: The Major Prophets (5)

#	Book	One word	Motion
1	Isaiah	Savior	Coal on lips → "Send me!"
2	Jeremiah	Warning / New Promise	Shape the clay
3	Lamentations	Tears	Tears → sunrise
4	Ezekiel	Glory / New Life	Floppy bones → stand tall
5	Daniel	Faithful	Lion jaws snap shut

Teacher Preparation

Background for the teacher

What is a prophet? In the Bible, a prophet is a person God chose to speak His words to His people. People often think "prophet" means "someone who predicts the future." Prophets sometimes did that, but mostly they were *covenant messengers*. They reminded Israel of the covenant (the binding promise-relationship) God made at Mount Sinai (Phase 2). Their message usually had three parts:

1. **"You have broken the covenant."** Idolatry (worshiping false gods), injustice to the poor, empty religion.
2. **"Judgment is coming if you don't turn back."** For Israel this meant invasion and exile (being carried away from the land).
3. **"But God will not give up on you."** After judgment comes restoration, a new covenant, and a coming King from David's family (the Messiah).

Where these books fit on the timeline. The Major Prophets fit inside the stories you taught in Phases 4 and 5 (Kings, Chronicles, Ezra, Nehemiah):

Approx. date (B.C.)	Event	Prophet(s) speaking
740	King Uzziah dies; Isaiah's call (Isaiah 6)	Isaiah
722	Assyria conquers the northern kingdom (Israel)	Isaiah (and Hosea, Amos, Micah next month)
701	Assyria's King Sennacherib surrounds Jerusalem; God rescues the city (Isaiah 36–37; 2 Kings 18–19)	Isaiah

Approx. date (B.C.)	Event	Prophet(s) speaking
627	Jeremiah is called as a young man	Jeremiah
605	First captives taken to Babylon, including Daniel and his friends	Jeremiah, Daniel
597	Second deportation, including Ezekiel and King Jehoiachin	Jeremiah, Ezekiel
586	Babylon destroys Jerusalem and the temple	Jeremiah, Lamentations, Ezekiel
539	Persia (King Cyrus) conquers Babylon; Daniel in the lions' den happens around this time under "Darius the Mede"	Daniel
538	Cyrus lets the Jews go home (Ezra 1); Isaiah had named Cyrus ahead of time (Isaiah 44:28–45:1)	—

Map notes. Draw (or print) a simple "arc" map: **Jerusalem** (Judah) on the left, **Nineveh** (Assyria) at the top, **Babylon** on the right along the Euphrates River. The trip from Jerusalem to Babylon was not straight across the desert. Travelers went north and around through the "Fertile Crescent," about 900 miles, which took roughly four months on foot (compare Ezra 7:9). Ezekiel lived by the **Kebar River** (a canal near Babylon). Daniel lived in the city of Babylon, and later served in the Persian government.

Key truths to emphasize

- **God speaks.** He is not silent. He tells His people the truth even when it's hard to hear (Isaiah 40:8: His word lasts forever).
- **Sin has real consequences**, but **God's love is bigger** than our sin (Lamentations 3:22–23).
- **God keeps His promises.** The prophets' predictions came true: Jerusalem fell (as warned), the people came home (as promised), and the Messiah came (as promised).
- **God is with His people even in hard places.** In Babylon, God was with Ezekiel by the river and with Daniel in the lions' den.
- **Faithfulness matters**, even when you're young (Jeremiah, Daniel and his friends were teenagers or young adults).
- **Jesus is the King the prophets were waiting for.**

Handling sensitive content by age

Topic	Little Lambs (4–6)	Explorers (7–10)	Trailblazers (11–13)	Ambassadors (14–17)
Destruction of Jerusalem / war	"A strong army came and broke the city. The people had to move far away."	Explain the army, the broken walls and temple, and the long walk to Babylon.	Discuss *why* (2 Kings 24–25, 2 Chronicles 36:15–16: God warned for a long time).	Discuss judgment and mercy together; God's patience; exile as discipline, not abandonment.
Lions & the furnace	Focus on God's protection; "the lions' mouths were shut."	Tell the whole story; it's exciting.	Discuss Daniel 3:18 "even if he does not": faith that trusts God no matter what.	Discuss martyrdom honestly: God doesn't always rescue from death, but He always keeps us (Hebrews 11:32–38).

Topic	Little Lambs (4–6)	Explorers (7–10)	Trailblazers (11–13)	Ambassadors (14–17)
The accusers thrown to the lions (Dan. 6:24)	Skip.	Simply: "The bad men who tricked the king were punished."	Mention it briefly; it was the Persian king's decision.	Discuss ancient justice vs. God's justice.
Lamentations' graphic famine imagery (e.g., 4:10)	Skip.	Skip.	"The city was starving. It was terrible."	May read with discussion, if appropriate for your group.
Ezekiel's adult imagery (chs. 16 & 23)	Skip.	Skip.	Skip.	Summarize only: "God compares His people's idolatry to an unfaithful marriage."
Ezekiel's wife's death (24:15–18)	Skip.	Skip.	Optional: God's prophet obeyed even in deep grief.	Optional discussion on grief and obedience.

Common kid questions (with simple answers)

1. **"Are prophets still around today?"** God still speaks today, mostly through the Bible, His Word. The Old Testament prophets had a special job that was finished when Jesus came (Hebrews 1:1–2: "In the past God spoke... through the prophets... but in these last days he has spoken to us by his Son").
2. **"Why didn't the people listen?"** Their hearts had grown hard. They liked their idols and doing things their own way. We can be the same, so we ask God for a soft heart (Ezekiel 36:26).
3. **"Was the fourth man in the furnace Jesus?"** The Bible doesn't tell us for sure. The king said he looked like "a son of the gods" (Daniel 3:25). Many Christians believe it was an angel or even a special appearance of God's Son before He was born as a baby. What we know for sure is that God was with them in the fire.
4. **"Did Daniel get hurt by the lions?"** No! "No wound was found on him, because he had trusted in his God" (Daniel 6:23).
5. **"Could dry bones really come alive?"** Ezekiel 37 was a vision, a picture God showed Ezekiel to teach that He can bring His people back to life after the exile. But God *really does* raise the dead. He raised Jesus, and He will raise everyone who trusts in Jesus one day!
6. **"Why is it called Lamentations?"** A "lament" is a sad song or a cry to God. It's okay to tell God when you're sad. He wants to hear it.
7. **"How did Isaiah know about Jesus 700 years early?"** God knows everything, even the future, and He told Isaiah. That's one reason we can trust the Bible.
8. **"Why did Daniel eat only vegetables?"** He didn't want to break God's food laws or be "defiled" by the king's food (Daniel 1:8). He wanted to obey God even in small things, and he was polite and wise about it.

Month at a Glance

Week	Passage	Lesson Title	Key Point	📺 Video	🎮 Game	🖍️ Activity
1	Isaiah 6:1–8; 9:6–7; 53:4–6	"Here Am I, Send Me!"	God calls messengers, and Isaiah pointed to Jesus the Savior.	BibleProject "Overview: Isaiah 1-39"; Sharefaith Kids "Isaiah"; Bible Journey "Isaiah"	Prophet Says (Messenger Relay)	Megaphone Craft
2	Jeremiah 1:4–10; 18:1–6; 38:1–13; Lamentations 3:22–23	"Clay in the Potter's Hands"	God shapes us, warns us, and His love is new every morning.	BibleProject "Overview: Jeremiah" & "Overview: Lamentations"; Sharefaith Kids "Jeremiah"; Bible Journey "Jeremiah"	Potter's Shape-Up	Clay/Play-Dough Pots
3	Ezekiel 1:1, 26–28; 37:1–14	"Dry Bones, Live!"	God can bring new life to anything, even dry bones.	BibleProject "Overview: Ezekiel 1-33" & "Ezekiel 34-48"; Sharefaith Kids "Ezekiel Dry Bones"; Bible Journey "Ezekiel"	Dry Bones Freeze Tag	Q-tip Skeleton Craft
4	Daniel 1; 3; 6	"Brave in Babylon"	Stay faithful to God. He is with us in the fire and in the lions' den.	BibleProject "Overview: Daniel"; Sharefaith Kids "Daniel and the Lions' Den"; Bible Journey "Daniel"	Lions' Den Sneak	Lion Paper-Plate Masks
5 *(optional)*	Review all 5 books	"Messenger Mania Review Sunday"	God's word lasts forever, and it all points to Jesus.	Favorite clip review + BibleProject "Messiah"	Major Prophet Mega-Relay	Passport Stamp & Badge Ceremony

Weekly Lessons

Week 1: "Here Am I, Send Me!" (Isaiah)

Scripture: Isaiah 6:1–8; Isaiah 9:6–7; Isaiah 53:4–6

Lesson goal: Kids will learn that a prophet is God's messenger, that Isaiah said "Send me!" to God, and that Isaiah pointed to Jesus, the Child who would be born and the Servant who would die for our sins.

Opening hook / object lesson: "The Sealed Message"

- *Supplies:* An envelope marked "TOP SECRET MESSAGE FROM THE KING," a paper inside reading "A CHILD IS COMING. HIS NAME WILL BE MIGHTY GOD, PRINCE OF PEACE," a toy crown, a party horn or rolled-up paper megaphone.
- *Do:* Hold up the envelope. "I have a message from the King! But a message isn't any good if nobody tells it. I need a messenger!" Pick a volunteer, give them the megaphone and have them read the message loudly. Say: "God has messages too. The people He picked to tell His messages are called **prophets**. Today we meet one of God's biggest messengers: Isaiah!"

📖 **Story script (read aloud):**

> A long, long time ago, in the city of Jerusalem, there lived a man named Isaiah. The king of the land, King Uzziah, had just died. People were worried. "Who will take care of us now?"
>
> Then one day, God gave Isaiah a vision, like a dream while he was awake. Isaiah saw the Lord sitting on a throne, high and lifted up! God's royal robe was so long that it filled the whole temple. Above Him flew amazing creatures called seraphim. Each one had six wings. With two wings they covered their faces, with two they covered their feet, and with two they flew. They called out to each other, "Holy, holy, holy is the LORD Almighty; the whole earth is full of his glory!" The doorposts shook, and the temple filled with smoke!
>
> Isaiah was scared. "Oh no!" he cried. "I'm not good enough to be here! I have said wrong things with my lips, and so have my people!"
>
> Then one of the seraphim flew to the altar, picked up a burning hot coal with tongs, and flew to Isaiah. He touched the coal to Isaiah's lips and said, "Your guilt is taken away and your sin is forgiven."
>
> Then Isaiah heard God's voice: "Whom shall I send? And who will go for us?"
>
> Isaiah didn't wait. He said, "Here am I. Send me!"
>
> So God made Isaiah His messenger. Some of the messages were hard: "Stop doing wrong. Stop praying to fake gods. Help the poor!" But some of Isaiah's messages were the most wonderful news ever. God told Isaiah about Someone who was coming:
>
> "For to us a child is born, to us a son is given... And he will be called Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace."
>
> God also told Isaiah that this special Person would be a Servant who would suffer for other people's sins: "He was pierced for our transgressions... and by his wounds we are healed."
>
> Who was Isaiah talking about? Seven hundred years later, a baby was born in Bethlehem. His name was **Jesus**. He grew up and died on the cross for our sins, and He rose again! Isaiah's message came true, because God's word lasts forever.
>
> And guess what? God is still asking, "Whom shall I send?" You can tell people about Jesus too. You can say, "Here am I. Send me!"

Age-group teaching tips:

- **Little Lambs:** Act it out: flap "six wings" (arms, hands over face, hands over feet), shout "Holy, holy, holy!", touch lips gently, then raise hands: "Send me!" Keep the main idea: *A prophet tells God's message.*
- **Explorers:** Have kids find Isaiah in their Bibles (just after Song of Songs, the first Major Prophet). Count the seraphim's wings together. Emphasize Isaiah 9:6 names.
- **Trailblazers:** Compare Isaiah 7:14 with Matthew 1:22–23 and Isaiah 53:5 with 1 Peter 2:24. Ask: "How could Isaiah write this 700 years early?"
- **Ambassadors:** Read Isaiah 53 in full. Discuss "substitution" (Jesus taking our place). Have them prepare a 2-minute "send me" testimony to share with a younger group.

Discussion questions:

- *Little Lambs:* (1) What did the angels with six wings say? ("Holy, holy, holy!") (2) What did Isaiah say to God? ("Send me!") (3) Who is the special baby Isaiah talked about? (Jesus!)
- *Explorers:* (1) Why was Isaiah scared when he saw God? (2) What did the hot coal mean? (Forgiveness, his sin was taken away.) (3) Name one of the four names in Isaiah 9:6.
- *Trailblazers:* (1) Why do you think Isaiah had to be forgiven *before* he was sent? (2) What does "holy" mean? (Set apart, totally pure, different from everything else.) (3) Which part of Isaiah 53 sounds most like the cross?
- *Ambassadors:* (1) Isaiah was willing before he knew how hard the job would be (6:9–13). What does that teach about following God? (2) How is Isaiah 53 one of the strongest evidences that the Bible points to Jesus? (3) Where is God "sending" you this year (school, team, family)?

📺 **Video for the week:**

Channel	Best for	Search term	Link
@SharefaithKids	Little Lambs & Explorers	"Isaiah" (or "Isaiah's Vision" / "Here I Am Send Me")	https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=Isaiah
@BibleJourneyTV	Explorers & Trailblazers	"Isaiah"	https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Isaiah
@bibleproject	Trailblazers & Ambassadors (Explorers with pauses)	"Overview: Isaiah 1-39" (and part 2: "Overview: Isaiah 40-66")	https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Overview+Isaiah

Preview every video before class. Follow-up questions: (1) What did the video show about why God sent Isaiah? (2) What promise about the future did you hear?

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Prophet Says (Messenger Relay)*, see Games #1.

🖍️ **Activity of the week:** *Megaphone Craft*, see Activities #1. Coloring Page 1: "Isaiah's Vision."

🔤 **Memory / spelling focus:** Introduce the Memory Verse (Isaiah 40:8) and the section name **Major Prophets**. Spell **I-S-A-I-A-H**. Review the 22 books from previous phases with the cumulative chant.

🙏 **Closing prayer:**

> Dear God, You are holy, holy, holy! Thank You for forgiving our sins through Jesus. Here we are. Send us to tell others about You. Amen.

Week 2: "Clay in the Potter's Hands" (Jeremiah & Lamentations)

Scripture: Jeremiah 1:4–10; 18:1–6; 38:1–13; Lamentations 3:22–23

Lesson goal: Kids will learn that God can use young people, that God shapes us like a potter shapes clay, that Jeremiah kept telling the truth even when it was hard, and that God's love is new every morning.

Opening hook / object lesson: "Squish and Start Over"

- *Supplies:* A lump of clay or play-dough, a small bowl you made ahead of time from the same color, a lopsided "messed-up" pot.
- *Do:* Show the lopsided pot. "Oops! This pot didn't turn out right. Should I throw it away?" Squish it back into a ball and begin reshaping it. "A potter doesn't throw the clay away. He starts again and makes something good! That's exactly what God showed the prophet Jeremiah."

📖 **Story script (read aloud):**

> Jeremiah was a young man, maybe even a teenager, when God spoke to him. God said, "Before I formed you in the womb I knew you... I appointed you as a prophet to the nations."
>
> Jeremiah gulped. "But Lord, I don't know how to speak. I am too young!"
>
> God said, "Do not say, 'I am too young.' You must go to everyone I send you to and say whatever I command you. Do not be afraid, for I am with you." Then God reached out and touched Jeremiah's mouth and said, "I have put my words in your mouth."
>
> One day God said, "Jeremiah, go down to the potter's house." So Jeremiah went. He watched the potter spin his wheel round and round, shaping a lump of wet clay into a pot. But the pot got messed up in the potter's hands! So the potter squished it down and made it into a different pot, one that was just right.
>
> God said, "Like clay in the hand of the potter, so are you in my hand." God's people had gotten "messed up." They were worshiping fake gods and being unkind to the poor. But God was willing to reshape them, if they would turn back to Him.
>
> Jeremiah preached for forty years. Most people didn't want to listen. Some even laughed at him. Once, some leaders were so angry that they lowered Jeremiah with ropes into a deep, muddy well

called a cistern. There was no water, only mud, and Jeremiah sank down into it!

But a kind man named Ebed-Melek went to the king and begged for help. The king let him rescue Jeremiah. Ebed-Melek took thirty men, plus some old rags and worn-out clothes, and let them down on ropes. "Put these rags under your arms so the ropes won't hurt," he said. Then they pulled Jeremiah up out of the mud!

Sadly, the people still didn't listen. Just as Jeremiah warned, the Babylonian army came and broke down the walls of Jerusalem and burned the beautiful temple. Many people were taken far away.

Jeremiah was so sad that he cried. That's why he's called the "weeping prophet." The book of **Lamentations** is full of sad songs about the broken city. But right in the middle of all that sadness, there is a bright, shining hope:

"Because of the LORD's great love we are not consumed, for his compassions never fail. They are new every morning; great is your faithfulness."

Even when everything goes wrong, God's love is still there, fresh and new every single morning. And God promised Jeremiah that one day He would make a **new covenant**, a new promise, and write His ways on people's hearts. Jesus came to make that new promise come true!

Age-group teaching tips:

- **Little Lambs:** Give every child a small ball of play-dough to squish and reshape while you tell the story. Main idea: *God loves me and makes me new.* Do the "sunrise" motion for "new every morning."
- **Explorers:** Find Jeremiah and Lamentations in the Bible (right after Isaiah). Act out the cistern rescue with a jump rope and a "rag" (dish towel).
- **Trailblazers:** Read Jeremiah 31:31–34 and Luke 22:20. Discuss what makes the new covenant "new" (forgiveness and God's law written on hearts). Look at Jeremiah 29:11 *in context* (it was written to exiles who would wait 70 years; 29:10).
- **Ambassadors:** Discuss being faithful when you're not "successful." Jeremiah had few converts but obeyed for 40 years. How do we measure faithfulness? Look at the acrostic structure of Lamentations (chapter 3 has 66 verses: 3 for each of the 22 Hebrew letters).

Discussion questions:

- *Little Lambs:* (1) What did the potter make? (A pot!) (2) Where did the bad men put Jeremiah? (In a muddy hole!) (3) When is God's love new? (Every morning!)
- *Explorers:* (1) What excuse did Jeremiah give God? ("I am too young.") (2) What did God mean when He said we are like clay? (3) How did Ebed-Melek show kindness?
- *Trailblazers:* (1) Why do you think the people refused to listen to Jeremiah? (2) What does Jeremiah 29:11 mean when you read verse 10 too? (3) How is the "new covenant" connected to the Lord's Supper?
- *Ambassadors:* (1) Is it okay to lament (complain honestly) to God? What does Lamentations teach? (2) What's the difference between being *shaped* by God and being *crushed* by circumstances? (3) Where do you need to speak truth even if no one listens?

📺 **Video for the week:**

Channel	Best for	Search term	Link
@SharefaithKids	Little Lambs & Explorers	"Jeremiah" (or "Potter and the Clay")	https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=Jeremiah
@BibleJourneyTV	Explorers & Trailblazers	"Jeremiah"	https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Jeremiah
@bibleproject	Trailblazers & Ambassadors	"Overview: Jeremiah" and "Overview: Lamentations"	https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Overview+Jeremiah

Preview every video before class. Follow-up questions: (1) Why was Jeremiah called the "weeping prophet"? (2) What hope did God give, even after Jerusalem fell?

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Potter's Shape-Up*, see Games #2.

🖍️ **Activity of the week:** *Clay Pots with a Promise*, see Activities #2. Coloring Page 2: "Jeremiah at the Potter's House."

🔤 **Memory / spelling focus:** Spell **J-E-R-E-M-I-A-H** and **L-A-M-E-N-T-A-T-I-O-N-S** (clap the syllables: Lam-en-ta-tions = 4 claps). Say the Major Prophets so far: Isaiah, Jeremiah, Lamentations.

🙏 **Closing prayer:**

> Dear God, You are the Potter and we are the clay. Shape us to be like Jesus. Thank You that Your love is new every morning. Amen.

Week 3: "Dry Bones, Live!" (Ezekiel)

Scripture: Ezekiel 1:1, 26–28; Ezekiel 37:1–14 (optional: 36:26)

Lesson goal: Kids will learn that God was with His people even far away in Babylon, that God showed Ezekiel His dazzling glory, and that God can bring new life to things that seem completely dead, like dry bones (and like our hearts).

Opening hook / object lesson: "The Wilted Plant"

- *Supplies:* A badly wilted (droopy, not dead) potted plant, a cup of water. (Do this 2–3 hours before class: a wilted plant watered at the start of class will often perk up by the end. Check on it at closing!) Also a plastic Halloween skeleton or a picture of a skeleton.
- *Do:* "This plant looks pretty dead. Can it come back to life?" Water it and set it aside. "Let's see at the end of class!" Then hold up the skeleton: "But what about THIS? Can a skeleton come back to life? Today God shows a prophet something amazing."

📖 **Story script (read aloud):**

> Ezekiel was a priest. He was supposed to serve God at the temple in Jerusalem. But when he was a young man, the Babylonian army took him and many others far away to the land of Babylon. There was no temple there. Ezekiel lived by a river called the Kebar River, and he probably thought, "God is far away in Jerusalem. Is He even here with us?"
>
> Then one day, the sky opened up! Ezekiel saw a giant storm cloud flashing with fire. Inside were four amazing living creatures with wings, and next to them were wheels, sparkling wheels with wheels inside them, covered with eyes, moving in every direction! And above them all, on a throne like sapphire, sat Someone who glowed like fire, with a rainbow all around Him. It was the glory of the LORD!
>
> Ezekiel fell flat on his face. God was not stuck in Jerusalem. God was right there with His people in Babylon!
>
> Years later, God gave Ezekiel another vision. God's Spirit carried Ezekiel to a valley, and the whole valley was full of bones. Not just a few bones, but piles and piles of very, very dry bones.
>
> God asked, "Son of man, can these bones live?"
>
> Ezekiel said, "Sovereign LORD, you alone know."
>
> God said, "Prophesy to these bones and say to them, 'Dry bones, hear the word of the LORD!'"
>
> So Ezekiel preached to the bones. And then: *rattle, rattle, clack, clack!* The bones came together, bone to bone! Foot bones connected to leg bones, leg bones to hip bones! Then muscles and skin covered them. But they were still lying there with no breath.
>
> God said, "Prophesy to the breath!" Ezekiel did, and breath came into them. They came to life and stood up on their feet, a huge army!
>
> God explained, "These bones are my people. They feel dried up and hopeless. But I will open their graves and bring them back to their land. I will put my Spirit in you and you will live!"
>
> God also promised, "I will give you a new heart and put a new spirit in you."
>
> Kids, without God, our hearts are like dry bones: no life, no hope. But Jesus came to give us new life! When we trust Jesus, God gives us the Holy Spirit and a brand-new heart. And one day Jesus will raise His people from the dead for real, forever!

Age-group teaching tips:

- **Little Lambs:** Play "Dry Bones": everyone lies down "floppy." As you say "Toe bone! Leg bone! Knee bone!", they wiggle each part, then "BREATH!" and everyone jumps up. Main idea: *God gives life.*
- **Explorers:** Sing or chant the "toe bone connected to the foot bone" pattern (traditional spiritual "Dem Bones" is public domain). Find Ezekiel 37 in the Bible together.

- **Trailblazers:** Compare Ezekiel 10 (God's glory leaves the temple) with John 1:14 ("The Word became flesh and made his dwelling among us. We have seen his glory"). Discuss how Jesus is God's glory returning.
- **Ambassadors:** Read Ezekiel 36:25–27 and John 3:5 (Jesus to Nicodemus: "born of water and the Spirit"). Jesus expected Nicodemus, a teacher, to know Ezekiel! Discuss what spiritual "new birth" means.

Discussion questions:

- *Little Lambs:* (1) What was in the valley? (Bones!) (2) What did God give the bones? (Breath / life!) (3) Who gives us new life? (Jesus!)
- *Explorers:* (1) Where did Ezekiel live? (Babylon, by the Kebar River.) (2) What did God tell Ezekiel to say to the bones? (3) What does God promise to give us in Ezekiel 36:26?
- *Trailblazers:* (1) Why was it important for Ezekiel to see God's glory *in Babylon*? (2) What did the dry bones stand for? (God's discouraged people in exile.) (3) How is Jesus the "breath of life" for us?
- *Ambassadors:* (1) What's the difference between "fixing ourselves up" and receiving a new heart? (2) How does Ezekiel 37 point toward the resurrection? (3) Ezekiel was called a "watchman" (ch. 33). Who are you responsible to warn and encourage?

📺 **Video for the week:**

Channel	Best for	Search term	Link
@SharefaithKids	Little Lambs & Explorers	"Ezekiel Dry Bones"	https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=Ezekiel+Dry+Bones
@BibleJourneyTV	Explorers & Trailblazers	"Ezekiel"	https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Ezekiel
@bibleproject	Trailblazers & Ambassadors	"Overview: Ezekiel 1-33" and "Overview: Ezekiel 34-48"	https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Overview+Ezekiel

Preview every video before class. Follow-up questions: (1) What did the vision of God's glory teach Ezekiel? (2) What does the valley of dry bones tell us about God's power?

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Dry Bones Freeze Tag*, see Games #3.

🖍️ **Activity of the week:** *Q-tip Skeleton* (Explorers+), *Paper Bone Puzzle* (Little Lambs), see Activities #3. Coloring Page 3: "The Valley of Dry Bones."

🔤 **Memory / spelling focus:** Spell **E-Z-E-K-I-E-L** ("E-Z" sounds like "easy!"). Say all four Major Prophets so far. Check the wilted plant at the end of class!

🙏 **Closing prayer:**

> Dear God, You can make dry bones live! Please give us new hearts and fill us with Your Spirit.

> Thank You for Jesus, who gives us life forever. Amen.

Week 4: "Brave in Babylon" (Daniel)

Scripture: Daniel 1:8–17; Daniel 3:13–28; Daniel 6:1–23 (optional: 7:13–14)

Lesson goal: Kids will learn that Daniel and his friends obeyed God even in a land that didn't follow God, that God was with them in the blazing furnace and the lions' den, and that God's kingdom (Jesus' kingdom) lasts forever.

Opening hook / object lesson: "Stand Up Straight"

- *Supplies:* A tall paper "statue" (or a cardboard box tower) labeled "BOW DOWN!", a battery tea-light or orange tissue paper "fire," a stuffed lion.
- *Do:* Tell everyone: "When I hit this bell (or clap), everyone must bow down to the box!" Clap once and let everyone bow. Then whisper to one pre-chosen helper to stay standing. Clap again. Point at the helper: "Hey! Why aren't YOU bowing?" Helper says (rehearsed): "I only worship the one true God!" Say: "Today we meet some brave young people who wouldn't bow down even when a king commanded it."

📖 **Story script (read aloud):**

> When Daniel was a teenager, the army of Babylon took him away from his home in Jerusalem. He and his friends, Shadrach, Meshach and Abednego, were brought to the palace of the mighty King Nebuchadnezzar to be trained as royal helpers.
>
> The king offered them his fancy food, but Daniel decided he would not do anything that might break God's laws. He politely asked, "Please test us for ten days. Give us only vegetables to eat and water to drink." After ten days, Daniel and his friends looked healthier and stronger than everyone else! God gave them wisdom, and Daniel could even understand dreams.
>
> Later, King Nebuchadnezzar built a giant golden statue, ninety feet tall! He commanded, "When the music plays, everyone must bow down and worship this statue. Anyone who doesn't will be thrown into a blazing furnace!"
>
> The music played. *Toot! Twang! Boom!* Everyone bowed down... except Shadrach, Meshach and Abednego. They stood tall!
>
> The king was furious. But the three friends said, "Our God is able to save us. But even if He does not, we will never bow to your statue." The king made the furnace seven times hotter and had them thrown in!
>
> Then the king jumped up. "Didn't we throw three men into the fire? Look! I see **four** men walking around in the fire, unharmed!" God was with them in the flames! When they came out, not one hair was burned, and they didn't even smell like smoke!

> Many years later, Daniel was an old man working for a new king named Darius. Daniel did such a good job that some jealous leaders wanted to get rid of him. They tricked the king into making a law: "For thirty days, nobody can pray to anyone except the king. Anyone who does will be thrown into the lions' den!"
>
> Did Daniel stop praying? No! He went home, opened his windows toward Jerusalem, and got down on his knees and prayed three times a day, just like always.
>
> The jealous men caught him. The king was very sad, because he liked Daniel, but he had to keep his law. Daniel was thrown into a den of hungry lions, and a stone was placed over the opening.
>
> The king couldn't sleep all night. Early in the morning he ran to the den and called out, "Daniel! Has your God been able to rescue you?"
>
> And from inside the den came Daniel's voice: "My God sent his angel, and he shut the mouths of the lions. They have not hurt me!"
>
> Daniel later had a vision of "one like a son of man" coming with the clouds of heaven, and God gave Him a kingdom that would never end. Who is that? Jesus! Jesus called Himself "the Son of Man." Kings come and go, but Jesus' kingdom lasts forever!

Age-group teaching tips:

- **Little Lambs:** Use the stuffed lion. Let kids "roar," then clap hands over the lion's mouth: "God shut the lions' mouths!" Main idea: *God is with me when I'm scared.*
- **Explorers:** Count the four men in the fire using fingers. Find Daniel in the Bible (the last Major Prophet). Discuss: "What are things kids might be pressured to 'bow down' to?"
- **Trailblazers:** Look at Daniel 2 (the statue of four metals = four kingdoms) and 7:13–14. Talk about how Daniel predicted a series of empires (Babylon, Medo-Persia, Greece, Rome) followed by God's everlasting kingdom.
- **Ambassadors:** Discuss "even if he does not" (3:18): faith that isn't based on getting the outcome we want. Discuss how to live as a faithful Christian in a culture that doesn't share your faith (Daniel served the government well but would not compromise worship).

Discussion questions:

- *Little Lambs:* (1) Who was in the lions' den? (Daniel!) (2) How many men were in the fire? (Four!) (3) Is God with you when you are scared? (Yes!)
- *Explorers:* (1) Why did Daniel eat vegetables? (2) What did the three friends say to the king? (3) How many times a day did Daniel pray?
- *Trailblazers:* (1) Daniel kept praying even though it was against the law. When should we obey God rather than people? (Acts 5:29) (2) What do you think the "fourth man" teaches us about God? (3) Why do you think Jesus called Himself the Son of Man?
- *Ambassadors:* (1) How did Daniel stay faithful *and* respectful to pagan kings? (2) What "statues" does our culture ask us to bow to today (popularity, money, image)? (3) What does "even if he does not" faith look like when prayers aren't answered the way we hoped?

📺 **Video for the week:**

Channel	Best for	Search term	Link
@SharefaithKids	Little Lambs & Explorers	"Daniel and the Lions' Den" / "Fiery Furnace"	https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=Daniel
@BibleJourneyTV	Explorers & Trailblazers	"Daniel"	https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Daniel
@bibleproject	Trailblazers & Ambassadors	"Overview: Daniel" (bonus theme video: "Son of Man")	https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Overview+Daniel

Preview every video before class. Follow-up questions: (1) How did Daniel and his friends show courage? (2) What did the video say about God's kingdom?

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Lions' Den Sneak*, see Games #4.

🖍️ **Activity of the week:** *Lion Paper-Plate Masks*, see Activities #4. Coloring Page 4: "Daniel in the Lions' Den."

🔤 **Memory / spelling focus:** Spell **D-A-N-I-E-L**. Say all 5 Major Prophets in order with motions, and the whole memory verse. Begin oral check-offs (see End-of-Phase Review).

🙏 **Closing prayer:**

> Dear God, help us to be brave like Daniel and his friends. Thank You for being with us in hard and scary times. Thank You that Jesus is King forever! Amen.

Week 5 (optional): "Messenger Mania Review Sunday"

Use the End-of-Phase Review & Celebration plan below. Run the *Major Prophet Mega-Relay* (Games #5), finish oral check-offs, stamp Bible Passports, and award the 📯 "God's Big Messenger" badge.

Book Memory Song & Motions

🎵 "The Library Song: Major Prophets Verse" (tune: "Ten Little Fingers")

The tune is the familiar counting song "One little, two little, three little fingers..." Each verse = one section of the Bible library. Sing all the verses every week; it's cumulative! The new verse this month is Verse 4.

Verse 1: LAW (5)

> Genesis, Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers, Deuteronomy, the books of the Law! Genesis, Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers, Deuteronomy, FIVE!

Verse 2: HISTORY (12)

> Joshua, Judges, Ruth, and First and Second Samuel, First and Second Kings, then First and Second Chronicles, Ezra, Nehemiah, and Esther: History! Twelve books of HIS-TO-RY!

Verse 3: POETRY / WISDOM (5)

> Job and Psalms and Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, Song of Songs, they're Poetry and Wisdom! Job and Psalms and Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, Song of Songs, that's FIVE!

Verse 4: MAJOR PROPHETS (5), NEW!

> I-sai-ah, Jer-e-mi-ah, Lam-en-ta-tions, E-ze-kiel and Dan-iel, the Ma-jor Pro-phets! I-sai-ah, Jer-e-mi-ah, Lam-en-ta-tions, E-ze-kiel, Dan-iel: FIVE!

Tag (shout it!)

> Five plus twelve plus five plus five… TWENTY-SEVEN BOOKS, we're ALIVE!

(Teacher tip: Little Lambs can just shout "FIVE!" and do the motions; they don't have to sing every word.)

Hand motions for the new books

Book	Motion
Isaiah	Touch two fingers to your lips (the hot coal), then shoot your hand up: "Send me!"
Jeremiah	Cup hands and roll them in a circle like shaping clay on a potter's wheel.
Lamentations	Trace "tears" down your cheeks, then sweep arms up and out like a sunrise.
Ezekiel	Go floppy like loose bones, then snap up straight and tall.
Daniel	Open hands like a lion's jaws ("Roar!"), then clap them shut.

Review motions for books learned earlier (1–22). These match the motions used in earlier phases and the Books of the Bible Memory System:

Section	Book → motion
Law	Genesis: palms together like a book, open, sweep arms up (sunrise) · Exodus: walk two fingers across your palm and out the "door" · Leviticus: fold hands in prayer, then raise them high · Numbers: count 1-2-3-4 on fingers, then zig-zag your hand · Deuteronomy: two fingers up, tap your head, hand on heart
History	Joshua: march with a fist-trumpet · Judges: pound a gavel on your palm, then draw a circle · Ruth: scoop grain, then hug yourself · 1 & 2 Samuel: hold up 1 or 2 fingers, then cup your ear (listening) · 1 & 2 Kings: 1 or 2 fingers, then crown on head · 1 & 2 Chronicles: 1 or 2 fingers, then unroll a scroll · Ezra: stack fists like bricks · Nehemiah: hammer + shield · Esther: crown, then "speak up" hands at mouth
Poetry / Wisdom	Job: hands open up, then fold over heart · Psalms: strum a harp · Proverbs: tap your head with one finger · Ecclesiastes: blow a puff into your hand, then point up · Song of Songs: heart hands

📣 Section Shout

> **Teacher:** "Who are God's big messengers?" **Kids:** "FIVE MAJOR PROPHETS!" **Teacher:** "Name them!" **Kids (with motions):** "Isaiah, Jeremiah, Lamentations, Ezekiel, DANIEL!" **Teacher:** "What is a prophet?" **Kids:** "GOD'S MESSENGER!"

Cumulative recall drill (5 minutes)

1. **Section Stand-Up:** Call out a section ("Law!"). Kids stand and say the books in that section. Go in order: Law → History → Poetry/Wisdom → Major Prophets.
2. **Before & After:** "What comes after Song of Songs?" (Isaiah) "What comes before Ezekiel?" (Lamentations) "What's the last book of History?" (Esther)
3. **Count-Up:** Kids hold up fingers as they say each Major Prophet (5 fingers = one hand!). Then they "stack" it on the previous sections: 5 + 12 + 5 + 5 = 27.
4. **Speed Round (Explorers+):** Time how fast the class can say all 27 books in order. Write the time on the board and try to beat it each week.
5. **Missing Book:** Say the 5 Major Prophets but skip one. Kids shout which one is missing.

Tips for each age group

- **Little Lambs:** Focus on the section name "Major Prophets," the motions, and being able to say "Isaiah" and "Daniel." Celebrate any attempt!
- **Explorers:** Goal: say and spell all 5 new books and sing all four verses.
- **Trailblazers:** Goal: say all 27 books in order without the song, and give a one-word summary for each Major Prophet.
- **Ambassadors:** Goal: say all 27 books in order, lead the song for a younger class one week, and explain why they're called "Major."

Spelling & Reading

Spelling lists by age group

Little Lambs (letter recognition & first sounds)

Book	First letter	Sound it out	Picture clue
Isaiah	**I**	"eye"	🔥 coal
Jeremiah	**J**	"j-j-j"	🏺 pot
Lamentations	**L**	"l-l-l"	😢 tear
Ezekiel	**E**	"ee"	🦴 bone
Daniel	**D**	"d-d-d"	🦁 lion

Activity: hold up a big letter card; kids shout the book and do its motion. "D is for... DANIEL!" (roar and snap).

Explorers (book names)

1. Isaiah
2. Jeremiah
3. Lamentations
4. Ezekiel
5. Daniel
6. *Review:* Psalms, Proverbs, Esther, Nehemiah, Genesis

Trailblazers (book names + 5 vocabulary words)

- Book names: Isaiah, Jeremiah, Lamentations, Ezekiel, Daniel
- Vocab: **prophet**, **exile**, **Babylon**, **covenant**, **Messiah**

Ambassadors (book names + harder vocabulary with definitions)

Word	Definition
Prophet	A person who speaks God's message to people.
Exile	Being forced to live away from your homeland (Judah's exile to Babylon, 586–538 B.C.).
Lament	A song or prayer that pours out grief or complaint to God.
Acrostic	A poem in which each line or stanza begins with the next letter of the alphabet (Lamentations 1–4).
Covenant	A binding, promise-based relationship (God's covenant with Israel; the new covenant in Jesus).
Seraphim	Heavenly beings around God's throne (Isaiah 6); the name relates to "burning ones."
Messiah	"Anointed one": the promised King from David's line (Greek: *Christos*, Christ).
Sovereign	Having supreme power and authority; God rules over all kings and nations.

Word	Definition
Apocalyptic	A type of writing with symbolic visions about God's victory at the end of history (Daniel 7–12, Revelation).

👏 Syllable-clap method

Say each name slowly and clap once per syllable, then spell it in the rhythm of the claps:

- **I-sai-ah** (3 claps) → I · S-A-I · A-H
- **Jer-e-mi-ah** (4 claps) → J-E-R · E · M-I · A-H
- **Lam-en-ta-tions** (4 claps) → L-A-M · E-N · T-A · T-I-O-N-S
- **E-ze-ki-el** (4 claps) → E · Z-E · K-I · E-L
- **Dan-iel** (2 claps) → D-A-N · I-E-L

🏃 "Spell It Out" relay

1. Make two or more teams. Write each letter of a book name on a separate index card (one set per team) and scatter the cards at the far end of the room.
2. Call out a book ("JEREMIAH!").
3. One runner at a time runs, grabs ONE letter card in the right order, and brings it back. The team lines up the cards on the floor.
4. First team to spell the word correctly and shout its motion wins the round.
5. *Little Lambs:* Run to grab the first letter only. *Ambassadors:* Spell two books back-to-back without looking at a list.

🐝 Mini spelling bee word list (with sentences)

Word	Use it in a sentence
Isaiah	**Isaiah** said, "Here am I. Send me!"
Jeremiah	**Jeremiah** watched the potter shape the clay.
Lamentations	**Lamentations** says God's love is new every morning.
Ezekiel	**Ezekiel** saw dry bones come to life.
Daniel	**Daniel** prayed three times a day.
prophet	A **prophet** tells God's message.
Babylon	**Babylon** was a big city far from Jerusalem.
furnace	The king made the **furnace** seven times hotter.
lions	God shut the mouths of the **lions**.
potter	The **potter** made a new pot from the clay.
Messiah (Ambassadors)	The prophets said the **Messiah** would come from David's family.
covenant (Ambassadors)	Jeremiah promised a new **covenant**.

📖 Read-aloud practice passage

Have Explorers and older read this aloud, one sentence each. Little Lambs can repeat the bold words.

> God sent **prophets** to His people. A prophet is God's **messenger**. **Isaiah** saw God on His throne and said, "Send me!" **Jeremiah** watched a **potter** make a pot. He cried when Jerusalem fell, and he wrote sad songs called **Lamentations**. **Ezekiel** saw dry **bones** come alive! **Daniel** prayed to God, and God shut the **lions'** mouths. All the prophets pointed to **Jesus**, the King who would come. God's **word** lasts **forever**!

Word Trivia

⭐ Easy (Little Lambs / Explorers)

1. What is a prophet? (Multiple choice: a) a farmer b) God's messenger c) a king)
2. Who said, "Here am I. Send me!"?
3. True or False: Daniel was thrown into a den of hungry lions.
4. How many men did the king see walking in the fire?
5. What did the potter make out of clay?
6. Fill in the blank: "The word of our God endures _____." (Isaiah 40:8)
7. What did God do to the lions' mouths?
8. What came to life in Ezekiel's valley?
9. True or False: Daniel stopped praying when the king made a law against it.
10. What did Daniel and his friends eat instead of the king's food?
11. Which book has "Lament" (a sad song) in its name?
12. Fill in the blank: God's love is new every _____.

⭐⭐ Medium (Explorers / Trailblazers)

13. Who said, "I am too young"? (Who said it?)
14. Which book tells about the valley of dry bones? (Which book?)
15. What touched Isaiah's lips?
16. How many wings did each seraph have?
17. What were the names of Daniel's three friends (Babylonian names)?
18. Which king made a giant golden statue?
19. Who rescued Jeremiah from the muddy cistern?
20. Fill in the blank: "For to us a _____ is born, to us a son is given." (Isaiah 9:6)
21. Which book has the verse "For I know the plans I have for you"? (Which book?)
22. True or False: Lamentations comes right after Isaiah.
23. Who saw handwriting on the wall? (King Nebuchadnezzar or King Belshazzar?)
24. Where did Ezekiel live when he saw his visions?

⭐⭐⭐ Hard (Trailblazers / Ambassadors)

25. Who said, "But even if he does not... we will not serve your gods"? (Who said it?)
26. Which king burned Jeremiah's scroll piece by piece?
27. Which Persian king did Isaiah name about 150 years before he was born?
28. In what year (B.C.) did Babylon destroy Jerusalem and the temple?
29. In Jeremiah 31, what new thing did God promise to make with His people?
30. Which chapter of Isaiah describes the Suffering Servant who was "pierced for our transgressions"?
31. Fill in the blank: Jesus called Himself the "Son of _____," a title from Daniel 7.
32. What was Daniel's Babylonian name?
33. True or False: Four of the five chapters of Lamentations are acrostic (alphabet) poems.
34. What are the last words of the book of Ezekiel (the new name of the city)?
35. Which New Testament passage shows Jesus reading from Isaiah 61 and saying it was fulfilled?
36. Why are these five books called "Major" Prophets?

🔑 Answer Key

1. b) God's messenger
2. Isaiah (Isaiah 6:8)
3. True (Daniel 6)
4. Four (Daniel 3:25)
5. A pot (Jeremiah 18)
6. forever
7. He shut them (Daniel 6:22)
8. Dry bones (Ezekiel 37)
9. False, he kept praying three times a day (Daniel 6:10)
10. Vegetables and water (Daniel 1:12)
11. Lamentations
12. morning (Lamentations 3:23)
13. Jeremiah (Jeremiah 1:6)
14. Ezekiel
15. A live (burning) coal from the altar (Isaiah 6:6–7)
16. Six (Isaiah 6:2)
17. Shadrach, Meshach and Abednego
18. King Nebuchadnezzar (Daniel 3)
19. Ebed-Melek (the Cushite official), with the king's permission (Jeremiah 38:7–13)
20. child
21. Jeremiah (29:11)
22. False, Jeremiah comes right after Isaiah; Lamentations comes after Jeremiah.
23. King Belshazzar (Daniel 5)
24. In Babylon, by the Kebar River (Ezekiel 1:1)
25. Shadrach, Meshach and Abednego (Daniel 3:18)
26. King Jehoiakim (Jeremiah 36:23)
27. Cyrus (Isaiah 44:28; 45:1)
28. 586 B.C. (some scholars say 587)

29. A new covenant (Jeremiah 31:31–34)
30. Isaiah 53 (beginning at 52:13)
31. Man
32. Belteshazzar (Daniel 1:7)
33. True (chapters 1–4; chapter 5 has 22 verses but is not alphabetical)
34. "THE LORD IS THERE" (Ezekiel 48:35)
35. Luke 4:16–21
36. Because they are long books, not because they are more important.

Games

🎮 Game #1: Prophet Says (Messenger Relay)

- **Best for:** All ages (great for Little Lambs & Explorers)
- **Supplies:** A paper or plastic megaphone, a list of short "messages" (e.g., "Send me!", "Hop like a lion!", "Spell DANIEL!", "Say the 5 Major Prophets!")
- **Setup:** Kids line up at one end of the room. One "prophet" (start with the teacher) stands at the other end with the megaphone.
- **How to play:** Like "Simon Says," but kids only obey when the leader begins with **"The prophet says..."** ("The prophet says: shout 'Here am I, send me!'"). If the leader gives a command without "The prophet says," anyone who obeys takes one step back. Mix in book-name commands: "The prophet says: say the book that comes after Isaiah!" Correct answer = one step forward.
- **How to win:** First player to reach the prophet becomes the next prophet.
- **Adaptations:** *Younger:* No "out," just giggle and keep playing; use motion commands. *Older:* Add "Before & After" book questions and verse fill-ins; whoever answers first moves two steps.
- **Learning goal:** A prophet speaks God's message, and God's people listen and obey. Reinforces book order.

🎮 Game #2: Potter's Shape-Up

- **Best for:** Explorers, Trailblazers (Little Lambs with help)
- **Supplies:** None (or picture cards of shapes: pot, lion, bones, crown, scroll, megaphone)
- **Setup:** Groups of 3–5. One player is the "Potter"; the others are "clay."
- **How to play:** The teacher calls out a shape from this month's stories ("A LION!", "A FURNACE!", "A POT!", "DRY BONES!"). The Potter has 15 seconds to gently "mold" the clay kids into that shape (clay kids can move themselves as directed; no pulling or pushing). When time is up, the teacher calls "Freeze!" and checks shapes. Then the Potter must name the **book** where that shape belongs (Lion → Daniel). Rotate Potters.
- **How to win:** Teams earn 1 point for a recognizable shape and 1 point for naming the correct book. Highest score wins.
- **Adaptations:** *Younger:* Teacher is the Potter; kids just freeze in shapes. *Older:* Add hard shapes ("wheels within wheels," "Isaiah's seraph with six wings").
- **Learning goal:** God is the Potter; we're the clay (Jeremiah 18:6). Connects symbols to books.

🎮 Game #3: Dry Bones Freeze Tag

- **Best for:** All ages (very active)
- **Supplies:** Cones for boundaries; 1–2 "Breath" pinnies or scarves
- **Setup:** Choose 2 taggers ("Dry Wind") and 1–2 "Prophets" holding the Breath scarf.
- **How to play:** When a Dry Wind tags you, you become "dry bones": you flop down on the floor (sitting is fine). To come back to life, a Prophet must run to you and say, "Dry bones, hear the word of the LORD!" plus ask you a quick question ("Spell Ezekiel!" or "Name a Major Prophet!"). Answer it and you're "alive" again. Switch roles every 2 minutes.
- **How to win:** If the Dry Wind turns everyone into bones, they win; if the time ends with players still "alive," the Prophets win.
- **Adaptations:** *Younger:* The Prophet just touches you and says "LIVE!" *Older:* Questions get harder (book order, verse fill-ins, trivia).
- **Learning goal:** God's Word brings life (Ezekiel 37). Practices book names under pressure.

🎮 Game #4: Lions' Den Sneak

- **Best for:** Little Lambs, Explorers (Trailblazers as leaders)
- **Supplies:** A chair ("Daniel's prayer spot"), a blindfold (optional), a small "prayer" object such as a bean bag
- **Setup:** One child is "Daniel," kneeling at the chair. Everyone else is a lion, starting at the far wall.
- **How to play:** Similar to "Red Light, Green Light." When Daniel faces away, lions sneak forward (silently!). When Daniel turns around and says "My God shut the lions' mouths!", lions freeze with their mouths shut. Anyone caught moving or roaring goes back to the start. The first lion to tap Daniel's shoulder must say one Major Prophet (or the memory verse) and then becomes Daniel.
- **How to win:** Become the next Daniel by reaching the chair and answering correctly.
- **Adaptations:** *Younger:* Lions crawl on all fours; any answer like "Daniel!" counts. *Older:* Lions must say all five Major Prophets in order to win.
- **Learning goal:** Daniel's faithfulness and God's protection; book-name recall.

🎮 Game #5: Major Prophet Mega-Relay

- **Best for:** All ages (review Sunday)
- **Supplies:** 5 stations with signs (Isaiah, Jeremiah, Lamentations, Ezekiel, Daniel), a passport card per team, stickers or markers
- **Setup:** Mixed-age teams of 4–6 (Ambassadors lead teams). Each station has one task.
- **How to play:** Teams rotate through the stations in Bible order:
  - **Isaiah station:** Each person says "Here am I, send me!" and the team recites Isaiah 40:8.
  - **Jeremiah station:** Build a "pot" from play-dough together in 60 seconds and spell JEREMIAH.
  - **Lamentations station:** Do the tears-to-sunrise motion and say "New every morning!" Older kids say Lamentations 3:22–23.
  - **Ezekiel station:** Assemble a cut-up paper skeleton (the bone puzzle from Activities #3) in under 90 seconds.
  - **Daniel station:** Toss 3 bean bags into a "lions' den" box; for each miss, answer one trivia question instead.

- **How to win:** First team to collect all 5 station stamps and then sing the full Library Song (all 4 verses) wins. All teams that finish get a prize.
- **Adaptations:** *Younger:* Little Lambs get a buddy and do motions instead of reciting. *Older:* Add a timer and hard trivia at each station.
- **Learning goal:** Review all five books in order with the key story for each.

🎮 Game #6 (bonus): Handwriting on the Wall

- **Best for:** Explorers, Trailblazers, Ambassadors
- **Supplies:** Whiteboard or large paper
- **How to play:** Hangman style. A volunteer "writes on the wall" blanks for a book name, person or word from this phase ("NEBUCHADNEZZAR"). Teams guess letters. Each wrong guess adds a part to a drawing of a "hand" instead of a stick figure (5 fingers + palm = 6 misses).
- **How to win:** Guess the word before the hand is complete.
- **Learning goal:** Spelling the harder names; recalling Daniel 5.

Coloring Pages

> 🖍️ Printable book-name coloring sheet and word search: see `../printables/phase-07-printables.html`.

Page 1: "Isaiah's Vision" (Week 1)

- **Scene:** A great throne high up with a long royal robe flowing down like a waterfall to fill the bottom of the page. Two seraphim with six wings each (two covering faces, two covering feet, two spread out to fly). In the lower corner, Isaiah kneels with his hand raised. A small seraph holds tongs with a glowing coal near his lips. Smoke swirls along the edges.
- **Caption:** "Here am I. Send me!" (Isaiah 6:8)
- **Coloring conversation prompts:** "What color do you think God's glory looks like?" "Why did Isaiah need his sins forgiven?" "Where could God send *you* this week?"

Page 2: "Jeremiah at the Potter's House" (Week 2)

- **Scene:** A potter sitting at a spinning wheel, shaping a tall pot with wet hands. Jeremiah watches in the doorway. Shelves of finished pots line the walls. A sunrise peeks through a window (for "new every morning").
- **Caption:** "Like clay in the hand of the potter, so are you in my hand." (Jeremiah 18:6)
- **Coloring conversation prompts:** "What would you like God to shape in your life?" "What happens when the clay gets messed up?" "How is God's love new every morning?"

Page 3: "The Valley of Dry Bones" (Week 3)

- **Scene:** Split page. Left side: a valley full of scattered bones and dry, cracked ground. Right side: the same valley with people standing up tall, cheering, with wind swirls (God's breath) blowing through. Ezekiel stands in the middle with arms raised.
- **Caption:** "I will put my Spirit in you and you will live." (Ezekiel 37:14)
- **Coloring conversation prompts:** "What color should the 'before' side be? The 'after' side?" "What does God's breath do?" "How does Jesus give us new life?"

Page 4: "Daniel in the Lions' Den" (Week 4)

- **Scene:** Daniel kneeling peacefully in the center, hands folded. Lions lying around him, one yawning with its mouth closed, one resting its head on its paws. A bright angel stands behind Daniel. Above, a stone opening with a sliver of morning light and the worried king peeking in.
- **Caption:** "My God sent his angel, and he shut the mouths of the lions." (Daniel 6:22)
- **Coloring conversation prompts:** "How do you think Daniel felt?" "When are you scared? How can you pray then?" "Who is always with you?"

Page 5: "The Fourth Man in the Fire" (bonus)

- **Scene:** A big brick furnace with tall flames. Inside, four figures walk freely, ropes falling off. Outside, King Nebuchadnezzar leans forward with wide eyes, pointing.
- **Caption:** "Our God is able!" (from Daniel 3:17)
- **Coloring conversation prompts:** "Why wouldn't the friends bow to the statue?" "What does 'even if he does not' mean?"

Page 6: "God's Big Messengers" book-name page

- **Scene:** Five big megaphones arranged like a fan, each labeled with a book: ISAIAH (with coal), JEREMIAH (with pot), LAMENTATIONS (with teardrop and sun), EZEKIEL (with bone), DANIEL (with lion). Banner across the top: "MAJOR PROPHETS: 5 BOOKS." Bottom: a purple crown with "Jesus is the King they pointed to!"
- **Caption:** "The word of our God endures forever." (Isaiah 40:8)
- **Coloring conversation prompts:** Say each book as you color its megaphone. "Which story is your favorite?"

Activities & Crafts

✂️ Activity #1: Megaphone Messenger Craft (Week 1)

- **Supplies:** Purple cardstock or construction paper (1 sheet per child), tape, stickers, markers, the printed message "GOD'S WORD LASTS FOREVER!" and optional ribbon.
- **Steps:**
    1. Decorate the flat paper with stars, crowns and the word "PROPHET."
    2. Write (or glue) Isaiah 40:8 along one edge.

3. Roll into a cone (narrow at one end), tape it shut and trim the wide end evenly.
4. Practice: shout "Here am I, send me!" and the five Major Prophets through the megaphone.

- **Age adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* Pre-roll cones; they add stickers. *Explorers:* Write all five book names around the cone. *Trailblazers:* Write one key verse from each Major Prophet. *Ambassadors:* Help younger kids; write their own "send me" commitment inside.
- **What it teaches:** Prophets were God's messengers. We share God's message too.

🏺 Activity #2: Clay Pots with a Promise (Week 2)

- **Supplies:** Air-dry clay or play-dough, toothpicks for writing, paper plates, small slips of paper with Lamentations 3:22–23 or Jeremiah 18:6 printed on them.
- **Steps:**
  1. Roll a ball of clay and press your thumb in the middle to make a "pinch pot."
  2. Use a toothpick to carve your initials and a small sun ("new every morning").
  3. If it gets lopsided, squish and start again! (Talk about God reshaping us.)
  4. Fold the verse slip and tuck it inside the pot to take home.
- **Age adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* Play-dough only; just squish and reshape. *Explorers:* Pinch pot plus verse. *Trailblazers/Ambassadors:* Make a coil pot and carve "NEW COVENANT" or "Jer. 31:33."
- **What it teaches:** God is our Potter. He doesn't throw us away when we mess up; He reshapes us.

🦴 Activity #3: Q-tip Skeleton / Paper Bone Puzzle (Week 3)

- **Supplies:** Black construction paper, cotton swabs (Q-tips), glue, white crayon or chalk, scissors. For Little Lambs: a pre-cut paper skeleton (head, body, 2 arms, 2 legs) and paper fasteners (brads).
- **Steps (Q-tip):**
  1. Draw a skull shape with white crayon at the top of the black paper.
  2. Glue cotton swabs (cut some in half) to make a spine, ribs, arms and legs.
  3. Write "Dry bones, hear the word of the LORD!" (Ezekiel 37:4) at the bottom.
  4. Add a "breath" swirl in bright color next to the skeleton.
- **Steps (paper puzzle):** Kids connect the skeleton with brads so it can "dance," then make it stand up as they say "LIVE!"
- **Age adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* Paper puzzle. *Explorers:* Q-tip skeleton. *Trailblazers:* Add labels for 5 real bones (skull, ribs, spine, femur, pelvis) for fun. *Ambassadors:* Write Ezekiel 36:26 and explain "new heart" to a younger buddy.
- **What it teaches:** God gives life to what was dead, a picture of new life in Jesus.

🦁 Activity #4: Lion Paper-Plate Masks (Week 4)

- **Supplies:** Paper plates, yellow and orange paint or crayons, yarn or strips of orange/brown paper for the mane, craft sticks, glue, markers, scissors.
- **Steps:**
  1. Color the plate yellow.
  2. Glue strips of paper or yarn around the edge for a mane.
  3. Draw a lion face with a **closed, smiling mouth** (God shut its mouth!).

4. Cut out eye holes (teacher helps) and tape a craft stick to the bottom for a handle.
5. On the back write: "My God shut the mouths of the lions." (Daniel 6:22)

- **Age adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* Pre-cut eye holes and manes. *Explorers:* Full craft. *Trailblazers:* Write the three times Daniel prayed (morning, noon, evening idea) on the mane strips with prayer requests. *Ambassadors:* Lead the younger kids in acting out the lions' den with masks.
- **What it teaches:** God is with us and protects us when we stay faithful.

⏳ Activity #5: Prophet Timeline Wall

- **Supplies:** A long strip of butcher paper, markers, the coloring pages or printed symbols, tape.
- **Steps:**
  1. Draw a long line labeled "740 B.C." at the left and "538 B.C." at the right, with "Jesus is born" far off the right end of the paper (with an arrow).
  2. Mark: Isaiah's call (740), Assyria attacks (701), Jeremiah's call (627), Daniel taken to Babylon (605), Ezekiel taken (597), Jerusalem falls (586), Daniel in the lions' den (about 539), the Jews go home (538).
  3. Kids tape the matching symbol (coal, pot, tear, bone, lion) at each prophet's spot.
  4. Draw arrows from each prophet's "Jesus promise" pointing to the far right: "JESUS!"
- **Age adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* Just place the pictures where the teacher points. *Explorers:* Place pictures and say the book name. *Trailblazers:* Add the kings (Hezekiah, Josiah, Zedekiah, Nebuchadnezzar, Cyrus). *Ambassadors:* Research and add the prophecies' New Testament fulfillments.
- **What it teaches:** The prophets lived in real history, and their messages all pointed forward to Jesus.

🎭 Activity #6: "Brave in Babylon" Skit

- **Supplies:** Simple costumes (crowns, towels as robes), a cardboard "statue," a sheet as the lions' den, stuffed lions.
- **Steps:** Ambassadors direct; Trailblazers and Explorers act; Little Lambs are "lions" and the "music" (shakers). Act out Daniel 3 and Daniel 6 in two short scenes. Perform for parents at pickup or on Review Sunday.
- **What it teaches:** Courage, prayer and God's faithfulness.

Word Puzzles

🔀 Word Scramble

Unscramble these words from Phase 7.

#	Scrambled	Hint
1	HAISAI	Said "Send me!"
2	REMJIEHA	Watched a potter

#	Scrambled	Hint
3	ATIONSLAMENT	Sad songs
4	KIEELEZ	Saw dry bones
5	NIDALE	Lions' den
6	HETPORP	God's messenger
7	LYNOBAB	Big city far from home
8	ROTTEP	Works with clay
9	ENOSB	Came to life in a valley
10	CANERFU	Very hot fire
11	NSOIL	Their mouths were shut
12	VENCOTAN	A new promise

Answer key: 1. ISAIAH 2. JEREMIAH 3. LAMENTATIONS 4. EZEKIEL 5. DANIEL 6. PROPHET 7. BABYLON 8. POTTER 9. BONES 10. FURNACE 11. LIONS 12. COVENANT

✏️ Fill-in-the-Blank Story

Word bank: Daniel, coal, potter, forever, lions, Isaiah, bones, Jesus, morning, prophets, Ezekiel, Jeremiah

> God sent big messengers called _____ to His people. _____ saw God on His throne, and an angel touched his lips with a hot _____. Young _____ went to the house of a _____ and watched him shape clay. Even when Jerusalem fell, God's love was new every _____. _____ saw a valley full of dry _____ that came to life! _____ prayed even when it was against the law, and God shut the mouths of the _____. All these prophets pointed to _____. The word of our God endures _____!

Answer key: prophets, Isaiah, coal, Jeremiah, potter, morning, Ezekiel, bones, Daniel, lions, Jesus, forever

🔗 Match the Book to Its Picture / Summary

Book		Picture / Summary
1. Isaiah		A. 🦁 Brave young men in Babylon; lions' den and fiery furnace
2. Jeremiah		B. 🦴 Visions of God's glory; dry bones live
3. Lamentations		C. 🔥 "Here am I, send me!"; "For to us a child is born"
4. Ezekiel		D. ☹️ Five sad poems; "new every morning"
5. Daniel		E. 🏺 The weeping prophet; potter and clay; a new covenant

Answer key: 1–C, 2–E, 3–D, 4–B, 5–A

Questions for Every Age

Little Lambs (4–6)

1. What does a prophet do? (Tells God's message.)
2. Who did Isaiah say was coming? (Jesus, a special baby!)
3. What can you do when you feel sad? (Talk to God; He loves me every morning.)
4. Who was with Daniel in the lions' den? (God and His angel.)
5. Who can you tell about Jesus this week?

Explorers (7–10)

1. Isaiah said "Send me!" What is one way you can serve God this week?
2. Jeremiah thought he was too young. Are you too young to obey God? Why not?
3. When you mess up, what does God do? (Forgives and reshapes us when we turn to Him.)
4. Daniel prayed three times a day. When could you pray every day?
5. What is something kids are pressured to "bow down" to instead of God?

Trailblazers (11–13)

1. Why do you think God kept sending prophets when people kept ignoring them?
2. What's the difference between a fortune-teller and a biblical prophet?
3. Which promise about Jesus from these books amazes you most, and why?
4. Daniel served a pagan king well but refused to worship his gods. Where is that line for you at school?
5. How can Lamentations help someone who is grieving?

Ambassadors (14–17)

1. How does fulfilled prophecy (like Isaiah 53 or Micah 5:2) strengthen confidence in the Bible?
2. Jeremiah obeyed for 40 years with very little "success." How do you define success as a Christian?
3. How do you lament honestly to God without losing faith? (See Lamentations 3.)
4. What does "even if he does not" faith look like in real life?
5. How can you be a "watchman" (Ezekiel 33) for your friends without being preachy?

🧠 Big Questions for Ambassadors (apologetics / worldview)

1. "Wasn't Isaiah 53 just written after Jesus to make Him fit?" *Suggested answer:* No. The Great Isaiah Scroll found among the Dead Sea Scrolls (at Qumran, discovered in 1947) contains the whole book of Isaiah, including chapter 53, and dates to roughly 125 B.C. That's more than a hundred years before Jesus was born. The prophecy was there first.

2. "If God is loving, why would He let Jerusalem be destroyed?" *Suggested answer:* God was patient for centuries, sending prophet after prophet (2 Chronicles 36:15–16). The exile was discipline meant to restore, not to destroy forever (Jeremiah 29:10–14). A loving parent doesn't ignore destructive behavior. God's judgment and His love work together, and both meet at the cross, where Jesus took judgment for us.

3. "Some people say Daniel was written much later, after the events it 'predicts.' How should we think about that?" *Suggested answer:* Some scholars date Daniel to the 160s B.C. because its prophecies are so accurate; they assume predictive prophecy is impossible. That's a starting assumption, not a proof. Many evangelical scholars hold to a 6th-century B.C. date based on the book's own claims, Jesus' reference to "the prophet Daniel" (Matthew 24:15), and features of its language and historical detail. Also, Daniel 7 and 9 look forward to a Messiah and a kingdom that extend beyond the 160s B.C., pointing to Jesus. If God knows the future, accurate prophecy is exactly what we'd expect.

End-of-Phase Review & Celebration

Review game plan (last Sunday)

1. **Welcome (10 min):** Sing all four verses of the Library Song with motions. Do the Section Shout.
2. **Speed Chant Challenge (5 min):** Each class tries to beat its best time saying the 27 books.
3. **Major Prophet Mega-Relay (25 min):** Games #5, mixed-age teams led by Ambassadors.
4. **Trivia Showdown (10 min):** Use the Word Trivia questions. Little Lambs answer ⭐ questions with a buddy.
5. **Oral check-offs (15 min):** Use the checklists below; Ambassadors and teachers listen.
6. **Passport & badge ceremony (10 min):** Stamp passports, award badges and certificates, then close in prayer.

✅ Oral check-off checklist

Little Lambs (4–6)

- ☐ Says the section name: "Major Prophets"
- ☐ Says at least 3 of the 5 books (with or without motions)
- ☐ Says the Little Lambs verse: "The word of our God endures forever."
- ☐ Tells one story in a sentence (e.g., "God shut the lions' mouths.")

Explorers (7–10)

- ☐ Says all 5 Major Prophets in order
- ☐ Spells all 5 books correctly (oral or written)
- ☐ Says Isaiah 40:8 from memory
- ☐ Sings the Library Song (all 4 verses)

Trailblazers (11–13)

- [ ] Says all 27 books so far in order (no song)
- [ ] Gives a one-sentence summary of each Major Prophet
- [ ] Says Isaiah 40:8 from memory
- [ ] Names one way each Major Prophet points to Jesus

Ambassadors (14–17)

- [ ] Says all 27 books so far in order
- [ ] Says Isaiah 40:8 and explains it
- [ ] Teaches one Major Prophet (story + motion + spelling) to a younger child
- [ ] Explains why they're called "Major" and what a prophet's three-part message was

🛂 Bible Passport stamp

Stamp the **Major Prophets** page with a purple megaphone stamp (or sticker). Kids write or trace: "I know 27 of 66 books!"

🏅 Badge: "God's Big Messenger"

A round purple badge with a golden megaphone in the center, five small icons around the edge (coal, pot, teardrop-sun, bone, lion), and the words "MAJOR PROPHETS · 5 BOOKS." Make it with cardstock and a safety pin, a sticker, or an iron-on patch for a class sash.

📜 Certificate wording

> **Purpose Church Sunday School God's Big Messenger Certificate**
>
> This certifies that _____ has completed **Phase 7: God's Big Messengers** and has learned the five Major Prophets: **Isaiah · Jeremiah · Lamentations · Ezekiel · Daniel**
>
> "The grass withers and the flowers fall, but the word of our God endures forever." (Isaiah 40:8)
>
> **Books learned: 27 of 66** Teacher: _____ Date: _____

Take-Home Family Page

> ✂️ *Copy or print this section and send it home.*

Dear Families,

This month at Purpose Church, our kids are meeting **God's Big Messengers**, the Major Prophets: **Isaiah, Jeremiah, Lamentations, Ezekiel and Daniel**. A prophet is a messenger who speaks God's words. These prophets warned God's people to turn back to Him, comforted them in hard times, and

promised that a Rescuer-King was coming: **Jesus!** Your child now knows **27 of the 66 books** of the Bible. Please help them practice at home!

📖 **Memory Verse:**

> "The grass withers and the flowers fall, but the word of our God endures forever." (Isaiah 40:8, NIV)
>
> *Little Lambs:* "The word of our God endures forever."

🎵 **This month's song verse (tune: "Ten Little Fingers"):**

> I-sai-ah, Jer-e-mi-ah, Lam-en-ta-tions, E-ze-kiel and Dan-iel, the Ma-jor Pro-phets! I-sai-ah, Jer-e-mi-ah, Lam-en-ta-tions, E-ze-kiel, Dan-iel: FIVE!

(Ask your child to show you the hand motions: coal on lips, shaping clay, tears to sunrise, floppy bones, lion jaws!)

🍽️ **Dinner-table questions:**

1. What is a prophet? Which prophet's story did you like best?
2. Daniel prayed three times a day, even when it was hard. When could our family pray together?
3. Isaiah said a baby would be born who would be called "Prince of Peace." Who was he talking about?

👨‍👩‍👧 **Family activity: "New Every Morning" breakfast** One morning this week, have breakfast together and read Lamentations 3:22–23 aloud. Each person shares one thing they're thankful God gave them "new" today. For extra fun, stick a sticky note on the bathroom mirror: "God's love is new every morning!"

📺 **Videos to watch at home** (search these on YouTube; parents, please preview):

- **Sharefaith Kids:** "Daniel and the Lions' Den," "Isaiah," "Ezekiel Dry Bones": https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=Daniel
- **Bible Journey:** "Jeremiah," "Daniel": https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Daniel
- **BibleProject (for older kids and parents):** "Overview: Isaiah 1-39," "Overview: Isaiah 40-66," "Overview: Jeremiah," "Overview: Lamentations," "Overview: Ezekiel 1-33," "Overview: Ezekiel 34-48," "Overview: Daniel": https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Overview+Isaiah

Next month: *Twelve Mighty Messengers*, the 12 Minor Prophets, including Jonah and the big fish, and the "400 Silent Years" before Jesus was born!